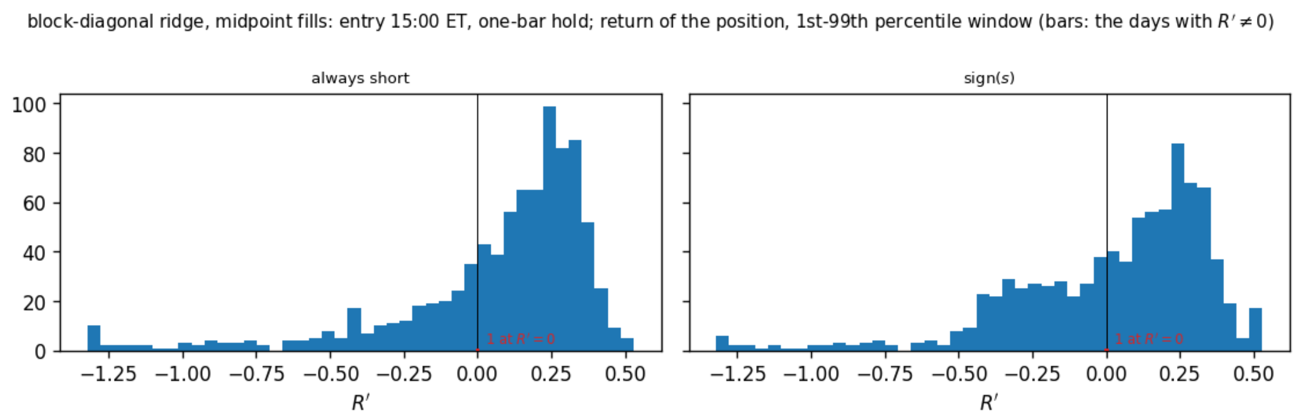
0DTE nearest-OTM package: per-rule return summary, entry 15:00 ET, one-bar hold, models compared on the same 866 days

	n	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	t	$\text{Sharpe}_{\text{ann}}$	$\text{Sharpe}^{\times}_{\text{ann}}$
Short volatility (always short)										
all models (no forecast)	866	0.060	0.379	-3.31	0.58	-3.03	15.14	4.64	2.51	0.18
sign(s) (± 1 *on the sign of* s)										
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	866	0.021	0.383	-3.31	2.85	-1.13	12.91	1.58	0.85	-1.43
block-diagonal ridge	866	0.030	0.383	-3.31	2.85	-0.94	13.04	2.28	1.23	-1.06
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	866	0.031	0.383	-3.31	2.85	-0.94	13.06	2.39	1.29	-1.00
LightGBM†	866	0.023	0.383	-3.31	2.85	-1.07	12.95	1.80	0.97	-1.31
XGBoost†	866	0.017	0.384	-3.31	2.85	-1.03	12.82	1.27	0.69	-1.59
lasso (causally tuned)†	866	0.031	0.383	-3.31	2.85	-0.80	13.02	2.39	1.29	-1.00
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	866	0.030	0.383	-3.31	2.85	-0.94	13.03	2.27	1.22	-1.07
elastic net (causally tuned)†	866	0.027	0.383	-3.31	2.85	-1.18	13.06	2.11	1.14	-1.15



Distribution of the return of the position taken at 15:00 ET, block-diagonal ridge forecast, one panel per rule (returns inside their 1st–99th percentile window).

One trade a day: enter the nearest-OTM package at 15:00 ET and exit thirty minutes later at the next stamp, in the same two strikes. 866 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck's frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule filled at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and exit at the touch of the next stamp; the 15:30 leg cash-settles and pays no exit spread, and a re-pick that lands on the same two strikes with the same sign is a hold, not a round trip, so it is not charged. One expiration day = one return; mid fill. Every t here is the plain $t = \sqrt{n} \cdot \text{mean/std}$, with no autocorrelation correction. "ex. kurt" is the bias-corrected sample excess kurtosis (Gaussian = 0). The short-volatility rule takes no forecast, so it is one row for all models. $\text{Sharpe}_{\text{ann}} = (\text{mean/std}) \times \sqrt{252}$; every other column is daily. The one column this table adds to the deck's is $\text{Sharpe}^{\times}_{\text{ann}}$, the same rule's annualized Sharpe at the *crossed spread* instead of the midpoint; every other column is the deck's.

Forecasts: baseline (HAR + calendar OLS); block-diagonal ridge (HAR block and exogenous block, separate penalties) on the design carrying the FOMC calendar block, and the same ridge on the earlier design without those columns, as a diagnostic row; LightGBM and XGBoost on the all-features design; lasso on the same design, causally tuned vs. fixed $\alpha = 10^{-4}$; elastic net (causally tuned). † marks a column still fitted on the earlier design panel; a run of those four on the panel of record is pending. The signal is $s_t = \widehat{RV}_t - \text{IV}^2_{\text{hr}} h_t w_t$: the forecast against the implied variance of the same window. On the bars whose vendor implied volatility is a censored solver node the deck's treatment is used here too — the volatility that reproduces the package midpoint, recovered by bisection over the remaining h_t hours — so every bar carries a signal and no bar sits flat.